KILLING IT · LLM MODEL EVALUATION

LLM Coach Benchmark

Six complete four-level plans from the test athlete, with Mercury 3 rerun on 28 October 2026.

1	6	6
BENCHMARK RUN	VALID PLANS	MODEL ENTRIES

What this report contains. For each model plan: the model name; full-plan and refresh cost/time; the season goal and rationale; the first block's name, focus and rationale; the first week's focus and rationale; and today's workout — or tomorrow's session when today is a rest day.

Plan text comes from each model's full build. The week + day refresh contributes cost and time only; its plan is not repeated here.

Mercury 3 was rerun after its first attempt failed schema validation; this report uses the successful rerun. The other five plans are from the 27 October run.

Source: benchmark results in `benchmarks/llm-coach/runs`. Cost is OpenRouter-reported and includes retries; time is wall-clock for the whole call chain. Plan text is reproduced from the model output.

Generated 2026-10-28 · Test athlete, user 1 · Full builds on 2026-10-26 and refreshes on 2026-11-02

Mixed run: five plans from 2026-10-27-six-model and Mercury 3 rerun on 2026-10-28. Gemini 4 Argon, Claude Haiku 5.5, DeepSeek V4.1 Flash, Mercury 3, MiniMax M3.1 Flash and GLM 5.3, with a 16,384-token plan budget.

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Benchmark: Google Gemini 4 Argon · 16,384 token budget

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RUN 1

2026-10-28-six-model-mercury-rerun

Benchmark	Google Gemini 4 Argon (google/gemini-4-argon)
Output budget	16,384 tokens per attempt
Full build	2026-10-26
Week + day refresh	2026-11-02
Plans	6 models

Cost and time summary

MODEL	FULL PLAN	REFRESH	TOTAL
Google Gemini 4 Argon	135.3 s / $0.1865	105.3 s / $0.1362	240.6 s / $0.3227
Claude Haiku 5.5	87.5 s / $0.0159	58.4 s / $0.0107	145.9 s / $0.0266
DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017	122.2 s / $0.0133	89.2 s / $0.0135	211.4 s / $0.0269
Inception Mercury 3	112.5 s / $0.0239	47.6 s / $0.0109	160.1 s / $0.0348
MiniMax M3.1 Flash	82.1 s / $0.0102	51.3 s / $0.0129	133.4 s / $0.0231
Z.ai GLM-5.3	68.3 s / $0.0307	68.8 s / $0.0393	137.1 s / $0.0701

Cost is the OpenRouter-reported cost, including retries and JSON repairs. Time is wall-clock for the whole call chain. Full-plan and refresh figures are shown separately, followed by their total.

PLAN 1 OF 6 · 2026-10-28-SIX-MODEL-MERCURY-RERUN

Google Gemini 4 Argon BENCHMARK

google/gemini-4-argon

Full plan	135.3 s / $0.1865
Week + day refresh	105.3 s / $0.1362
Total	**240.6 s / $0.3227**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-29

GOAL

Achieve sustainable fat loss (from 24.5% toward 15% body fat), resolve hip flexibility and lower-back limitations through progressive gym strength, complete the spring/summer SR brevet qualification series (200, 300, 400, 600 km) and long tour races at a strong pace, and peak for Paris-Brest-Paris (1200 km) in August 2027.

RATIONALE

Because you historically experience burnout after ~3–4 months of rigid, high-discipline training, this 44-week season is structured to protect your mental freshness through autumn and winter while steadily advancing your primary goals of fat loss, back/hip resilience, and multi-sport aerobic base. All pole vaulting, sprinting, and plyometrics have been completely removed. From late October through February, the focus is on enjoyable, low-stress multi-sport consistency—combining back-safe gym lifting, hip mobility, beginner running and rowing progressions, indoor ERG sessions, and Norwegian winter endurance (hiking, fatbiking, XC skiing, snowshoeing). This builds metabolic health and structural durability without draining your willpower. As road season returns in March, we transition into a focused 14-week disciplined cycling build and brevet progression (April 200 km to June 600 km), utilizing polarized indoor ERG intervals and outdoor endurance rides to restore your >280 W FTP and race fitness within your optimal 3–4 month focus window. A mid-summer recovery and ultra-endurance specialization block then locks in multi-day durability and riding comfort ahead of a two-week taper for Paris-Brest-Paris.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-06

Autumn Rebuild, Fat Loss & Structural Foundation

FOCUS

Re-establish consistent training habits with low mental stress. Prioritize caloric control and steady Zone 1–2 aerobic volume (indoor ERG rides, weekend mountain hikes) to drive fat loss without triggering severe post-workout hunger. Introduce a strict, back-safe gym lifting routine (goblet squats, controlled hip-hinges/RDLs, anti-rotation core work) and dedicated hip mobility to relieve sit-bone pressure and lower-back fatigue, alongside beginner run/walk and indoor rowing technique progressions.

RATIONALE

Following your summer detraining after the 1130 km July bikepacking race, this 6-week block builds a sustainable multi-sport foundation while respecting your 3–4 month limit on high-discipline cycling training. All pole vaulting, sprinting, and plyometrics are removed. By keeping all cardiovascular work strictly in Zone 1–2 (steady 140–160 W ERG rides, heart-rate-capped run/walks, beginner rowing technique, and long weekend mountain hikes or early-winter fatbike/snowshoe outings), we stimulate mitochondrial density and fat oxidation without triggering the intense post-workout hunger that derails evening calorie control. In the gym, we progress methodically from your initial 22 October session—adding the third goblet squat set, introducing light, strict-hinge Romanian deadlifts, and extending hip/hamstring

mobility beyond 10 minutes per session—to resolve your upright riding posture, sit-bone pressure, and lower-back vulnerability. Volume progresses in a gentle wave around your Sunday endurance anchors before a Week 6 deload transitions you fresh into the Norwegian winter base block.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Freshness for the 5-hour Sunday mountain hike anchor, steady Zone 1–2 ERG pacing (~140–148 W, HR <145 bpm), back-safe gym progression (3rd goblet squat set and light RDLs) with extended hip mobility, and an easy HR-capped run/walk restart.

RATIONALE

Following your unplanned 3h20 mountain hike in Selbu on Sunday 25 October (11.1 km, 608 m gain), Monday is kept as a full rest day to absorb that load. Tuesday steps onto the indoor trainer in ERG mode at a flat, disciplined 145–148 W (67% of your current 220 W working FTP, HR <145 bpm) to reinforce smooth aerobic pacing without triggering post-workout evening hunger. On Wednesday, we build directly on your 22 October gym session by adding the third goblet squat set at 12 kg, introducing light, strict-hinge Romanian deadlifts, and extending hip/hamstring mobility to a full 12 minutes to start addressing your upright cycling posture and lower-back resilience. Thursday re-establishes your beginner running progression with a strictly heart-rate-capped (120–135 bpm) run/walk, and Friday and Saturday are kept light and restorative so you arrive genuinely fresh for Sunday's 5-hour mountain hike durability anchor.

Today's workout

Tomorrow — 2026-10-27 (today is a rest day)

> Today, 2026-10-26, is a rest day: **Rest & Post-Hike Recovery** — Full rest day following yesterday's unplanned 3h20 Selbu mountain hike (11.1 km, 608 m elevation gain). Focus on hydration, balanced protein- and vegetable-rich meals after work to curb evening snacking, and 5–10 minutes of gentle supine hamstring or couch stretches if your lower back or hips feel tight from the climb.

Title	Steady Zone 2 ERG Ride
Type / intensity	workout / easy
Duration	60 min
Status	planned

DESCRIPTION

60-minute indoor trainer session in ERG mode focused on a completely flat, surge-free aerobic line. Warm up for 10 minutes at 99 W (45% FTP), then hold 148 W (67% FTP) for 40 minutes at a smooth 85–95 rpm cadence, keeping heart rate strictly below 145 bpm (if your legs still feel heavy from Sunday's Selbu hike or HR drifts toward 145 bpm, dial the main block down to 140 W). Cool down for 10 minutes at 99 W. Keep evening dinner portioned normally—this steady Zone 1–2 effort oxidizes fat efficiently without depleting glycogen or triggering intense post-workout hunger.

RATIONALE

After Monday's recovery day, a controlled 60-minute ERG ride at 67% of your current 220 W working FTP re-establishes smooth pedaling efficiency and aerobic fat oxidation without adding eccentric leg stress ahead of Wednesday's gym progression.

OPTIONALITY

This session builds the low-intensity mitochondrial efficiency and steady pacing discipline required for both sustainable fat loss (burning calories without spiking evening appetite) and multi-hour randonneur

brevets; skipping it costs you 60 minutes of controlled Zone 2 metabolic conditioning and leaves a gap in your weekly aerobic volume.

ALTERNATIVES

- 60-minute flat outdoor gravel or road spin capped strictly at 140–150 W and HR <145 bpm

Claude Haiku 5.5

anthropic/claude-haiku-5.5

Full plan	87.5 s / $0.0159
Week + day refresh	58.4 s / $0.0107
Total	**145.9 s / $0.0266**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-22

GOAL

Complete Paris-Brest-Paris in August 2027 comfortably, with a finishing series of randonneur brevets from April 2027 onward. Along the way, reach about 15% body fat, improve hip mobility and back resilience, and ride tour-length races at a decent pace.

RATIONALE

Winter 2026-27 is a low-intensity rebuild. The athlete is detrained after a July bikepacking race, and fat loss, hip and back work, and consistency come first. Disciplined training is limited to about four months, so the hard structured work (roughly March to early July) is concentrated there, with a gradual ramp before it. Base and strength come first (Block 2), then a spring transition that protects the back and prepares the tendons for road riding from March. Build 1 carries the 200 km brevet in April and the endurance and sweet-spot work that follows. Build 2 adds power and tour-race specificity, with the athlete's FTP recovering toward 280 W. A short peak block, then a taper and event block, match the August PBP timing. Easy, low-variability work is used through winter, and sustained intensity is kept to the disciplined build, following the athlete's own view that peak form can only be held for a few months. Winter outdoor riding uses the fatbike and studded tyres, with cross-country skiing and snowshoeing replacing sessions when conditions require.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-06

Rebuild and Fat Loss Foundation

FOCUS

Re-establish aerobic habit with easy, steady rides and a 5-hour hike anchor, back-safe gym strength, hip and spine mobility, and a modest calorie deficit with better evening and bedtime eating habits. No intervals, spinning classes, or plyometric and sprint work. Pole vaulting, sprints and plyometrics are removed.

RATIONALE

After the July bikepacking race the athlete is detrained, with a current FTP estimated at about 230 W against a 280 W reference. The block rebuilds consistency before any structured intensity. Each week uses a stable pattern: steady indoor ERG rides capped at 145 W with HR under 145, back-safe gym sessions that add load gradually (goblet squats at 12 kg progressing to a third set, then light Romanian deadlifts with a strict hinge), a short run/walk at HR 125-135 that builds toward 40 minutes, and a Sunday hike that grows toward the 5-hour anchor on 1 November with stops capped at 5 minutes and moving pace above 4.5 km/h. Volume rises gently over six weeks, with a lighter week 4 to absorb load. Hip and spine mobility reaches at least 10 minutes per session. Fat loss stays moderate, with dinner size and bedtime snacking as the main levers. Estimated FTP rises slowly from about 230 W to about 245 W as consistent load rebuilds aerobic fitness. Week 1 adds a deliberate rest day after the recent 25 and 27 October loads.

Winter gear and daylight are considered for outdoor work, and the athlete's stated comfort with darkness and cold is honoured.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Re-entry aerobic habit: steady indoor ERG at 145 W, back-safe gym strength, a short run/walk, and a 4-hour Sunday hike building toward the 5-hour anchor.

RATIONALE

Week 1 of the Rebuild block keeps intensity low and builds consistency. The 27 October strength session has already loaded the legs, so Tuesday is a full rest day. Wednesday and Friday gym sessions keep the back-safe pattern at the planned loads with no deadlifts yet. The run/walk stays at HR 125-135 with walk breaks. The Sunday hike is capped at 4 hours with stops of 5 minutes or less and a moving pace above 4.5 km/h. Total load stays near the 180-220 TSS target.

Today's workout

Today — 2026-10-26

Title	Indoor ERG endurance ride, 60 min at 145 W
Type / intensity	workout / easy
Duration	60 min
Status	planned

DESCRIPTION

10 min warm-up at about 90 W (HR under 125). 40 min steady at 145 W, cadence 85-95, HR under 145. If HR climbs above 145 before minute 15, drop to 140 W. 10 min cool-down at about 90 W. Finish with 10 min hip mobility: 90/90 hip switches, couch stretch 2x60 s each side, cat-cow 2x10, and hamstring floor reach attempts 2x45 s. Power targets are based on FTP 230 W.

RATIONALE

Today is the first day of the Rebuild block, and the last recorded load (25 October hike, 27 October strength session) has not yet been followed by a full rest day, so the intensity is capped at a flat 145 W ceiling. The steady line rebuilds aerobic habit without fatigue and sets up Sunday's 4-hour hike. Keep the first 10 minutes truly easy and let HR decide whether the main block stays at 145 W or drops to 140 W.

OPTIONALITY

This is the first structured session of the block and the start of the aerobic habit the 1 November 5-hour anchor depends on. Skipping it breaks the consistency the block is built on, so it should be completed.

ALTERNATIVES

- Indoor ERG ride at 140 W for 60 min if HR is elevated on arrival
- Easy 60 min road or gravel ride with HR under 135 if conditions are dry and you prefer to be outdoors

PLAN 3 OF 6 · 2026-10-28-SIX-MODEL-MERCURY-RERUN

DeepSeek V4.1 Flash 1017

deepseek/deepseek-v4.1-flash-1017

Full plan	122.2 s / $0.0133
Week + day refresh	89.2 s / $0.0135
Total	**211.4 s / $0.0269**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-29

GOAL

Complete Paris-Brest-Paris in August 2027 and the preceding randonneur brevet series, improve general cycling fitness for longer tour races, reduce body fat from 24.5% toward 15%, and build hip/core strength and flexibility while remaining injury-free and motivated.

RATIONALE

The season is shaped around the athlete's history of good progress for roughly four months of disciplined training, the need to rebuild after detraining, and the long runway to Paris-Brest-Paris. October to early December is a low-pressure rebuild focused on consistency, easy aerobic work, back-safe strength, hip mobility, beginner run/walk and rowing, and sustainable fat-loss habits. Winter is used as a broad aerobic base with cross-country skiing, snowshoeing, fatbike riding, indoor rowing and trainer sessions rather than forcing high-discipline road work too early. From February the plan shifts toward cycling-specific build and brevet preparation as tarmac returns, with the April 200 km and the spring 300/400/600 series acting as key specificity and pacing rehearsals. After the brevet series there is a short general-fitness and tour-race sharpening block before PBP-specific ultra-endurance work, equipment and night-riding practice, and a two-week taper. Intensity is concentrated in the later build and specialization phases, while strength and mobility are maintained at low volume to protect the back and hips. The plan deliberately avoids unnecessary work, uses recovery weeks, and reserves the most structured load for the final 16-20 weeks before PBP so the athlete peaks when it counts rather than burning out early.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-06

Rebuild & Fat-Loss Foundation

FOCUS

Re-establish training consistency after detraining with easy aerobic cycling, hiking, indoor rowing, beginner run/walk progression, back-safe full-body gym strength, hip mobility and core flexibility, and sustainable fat-loss habits. No pole vault, sprint or plyometric work.

RATIONALE

Week 1 is adjusted to reflect the unplanned 25 Oct hike and 27 Oct strength session: Wednesday strength becomes mobility, Tuesday's ERG ride is not added on top, and the week stays easy around the Sunday 5-hour hike. FTP estimates remain conservative at 220 W now and only rise slowly with completed consistent load. The block keeps its original focus and dates; no intensity is introduced before the winter base.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Deliberately light re-entry week: easy aerobic rhythm, back-safe strength/mobility, and protection of Sunday's 5-hour hiking anchor. No intensity, no pole vault, sprint or plyometric work.

RATIONALE

The unplanned 3h20 Selbu hike on 25 Oct and the recorded 21-minute strength session on 27 Oct already added load, so Tuesday's planned ERG ride is treated as replaced by that strength session and Wednesday's full gym routine is reduced to gentle mobility. The only aerobic work besides Sunday's 5-hour hike is a short easy trainer spin and a very easy run/walk. FTP is held at 220 W because no consistent aerobic load has been completed yet in this rebuild.

Today's workout

Today — 2026-10-26

Title	Easy indoor trainer spin
Type / intensity	workout / easy
Duration	30 min
Status	planned

DESCRIPTION

30 min easy ERG: 5 min warm-up at 55% FTP (121 W), 20 min steady at 65% FTP (143 W) with HR under 145, 5 min cool-down at 50% (110 W). Keep it flat and easy; if legs are heavy from Sunday's hike, reduce the main block to 60% FTP.

RATIONALE

After yesterday's 3h20 hike, a short flat ERG spin restores aerobic rhythm without adding meaningful fatigue. Keep HR under 145 and reduce to 60% FTP if the legs feel heavy, because Sunday's 5-hour hike is the week's anchor.

OPTIONALITY

This low-cost aerobic touch supports consistency and fat-loss habits without compromising Sunday's hike. Skipping it would cost little today, but completing it keeps the re-entry week coherent; shorten or rest if fatigue is high.

ALTERNATIVES

- 20 min easy walk
- 15 min gentle hip mobility
- Full rest if legs are heavy from Sunday's hike

PLAN 4 OF 6 · 2026-10-28-SIX-MODEL-MERCURY-RERUN

Inception Mercury 3

inception/mercury-3

Full plan	112.5 s / $0.0239
Week + day refresh	47.6 s / $0.0109
Total	**160.1 s / $0.0348**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-29

GOAL

Complete Paris-Brest-Paris in August 2027, lose body fat from 24.5% to ~15%, and improve hip/core flexibility and back-safe strength.

RATIONALE

The athlete is detrained (FTP est. 220 W vs 280 W when fit) after a successful July 2026 bikepacking race, and ranks fat loss as the top priority. The season intentionally front-loads low-pressure, habit-rich autumn/winter work (blocks 1-2) to rebuild the aerobic base, establish consistent movement, address hip/back limitations with specific mobility and back-safe strength, and integrate beginner run/rowing programs—without triggering the ~4-month discipline plateau he has experienced. When Norwegian roads clear in March, a short Spring Cycling Build transitions to bike-specific volume so the 200 km April brevet is comfortable. The Brevet Campaign then becomes the first truly disciplined block: completing the 200-300-400-600 km qualifiers while also building tempo/threshold fitness for tour-style races. The final PBP Peak block holds 6-8 weeks of specific long-ride preparation (including night riding and back-to-back duration) before a 2-3 week taper, guaranteeing peak freshness at the start line.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-27

Rebuild & Foundation

FOCUS

Rebuild aerobic base, back-safe strength, hip mobility, and fat-loss habits from a detrained state.

RATIONALE

The block starts with a low-intensity re-entry phase to rebuild aerobic fitness after a long layoff, while prioritizing back-safe strength and hip mobility to address the athlete's known limitations. The athlete has a history of a ~4-month discipline plateau, so the block is intentionally gradual and habit-focused. The initial weeks are light, with a clear progression toward a ~7-hour peak volume by weeks 7-8, followed by a taper. The plan also integrates beginner running and rowing, and uses indoor erg rides for controlled intensity. The block respects the athlete's winter constraints (ski, snowshoe, fatbike) when they become necessary, but the early weeks use the available outdoor and indoor options.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Re-entry: easy aerobic base, first gym session, Sunday 5-hour hike anchor

RATIONALE

This is the first week of the Rebuild & Foundation block. The athlete is detrained after the July 2026 bikepacking race and a long layoff, with an estimated FTP of 220 W (vs 280 W when fit). The week is deliberately light and easy to re-establish consistent habits, protect the back, and build aerobic base without triggering the discipline plateau. The unplanned 3h20 Selbu hike on 25 Oct was a solid aerobic effort but adds load, so the week is kept modest. The highlight is Sunday's 5-hour hike as the long aerobic anchor, with all rides capped at low power and HR. Strength is limited to one gym session with back-safe exercises (goblet squats, light RDLs, core) plus mobility/stretching. The beginner run/walk is reintroduced as a short, easy session. The recorded 10/27 strength session is partially completed, so the ERG ride is moved to Wednesday and Friday to maintain aerobic volume.

Today's workout

Tomorrow — 2026-10-27 (today is a rest day)

> Today, 2026-10-26, is a rest day: **Rest** — Full rest day. Brief 10-minute hip mobility and stretching (hip flexors, hamstrings, glutes) if desired. No structured training.

Title	Back-Safe Strength (Recorded)
Type / intensity	workout / moderate
Duration	21 min
Status	partial

DESCRIPTION

Recorded strength session: approx 21 minutes of goblet squats, glute bridges, lat pulldowns, Pallof press, plank, and stretching. This replaced the planned ERG ride.

RATIONALE

This session builds the back-safe strength and hip mobility needed to support long cycling and prevent back strain. The partial completion still provides a stimulus, but the low volume means we will prioritize recovery and adjust the rest of the week to maintain overall load.

OPTIONALITY

This session addresses hip mobility and back strength, which are critical for cycling comfort and injury prevention; skipping it would delay progress.

ALTERNATIVES

- Easy ERG ride if you skipped the strength session

PLAN 5 OF 6 · 2026-10-28-SIX-MODEL-MERCURY-RERUN

MiniMax M3.1 Flash

minimax/minimax-m3.1-flash

Full plan	82.1 s / $0.0102
Week + day refresh	51.3 s / $0.0129
Total	**133.4 s / $0.0231**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-15

GOAL

Peak for Paris-Brest-Paris in August 2027: complete a 200 km brevet in April 2027 and the brevet series comfortably, while losing body fat from 24.5% to ~15%, rebuilding back-safe strength and hip mobility, and finishing the season with general cycling fitness good enough for ordinary (long/tour) road races.

RATIONALE

The athlete is coming off a detrained summer (FTP ~220 W vs 280 W peak) and has a self-identified ceiling of roughly four months of disciplined training before motivation and progress stall. The season is therefore shaped as a long, low-intensity habit-and-base phase (autumn and winter) followed by a single concentrated, disciplined build (spring to midsummer) that ends with a short taper into PBP. Block 1 rebuilds the aerobic engine with flat ERG work, hiking durability, easy run-walk and back-safe gym work while the fat-loss deficit is easiest to sustain; it deliberately excludes all vault, sprint and plyometric content. Block 2 keeps the same aerobic base through the Norwegian winter using fatbike, cross-country skiing, snowshoeing, indoor rowing and gym strength, with volume maintained but intensity minimal so the athlete stays fresh for the build and does not lose the base between seasons. Block 3 (March) is the start of the disciplined phase: tarmac road riding returns, FTP targets rise from ~220 W toward 270 W, the 200 km brevet in April serves as the first A-race, and the beginner 5K running and rowing progressions continue alongside. Block 4 is race-specific: long low-torque endurance rides, threshold and VO2-max work in ERG mode, back-safe strength to fix hip hinge and squat tolerance, and long weekend durability sessions that build toward 18+ hours of riding. Block 5 is a 4-week taper with reduced volume, retained intensity, and race sharpening for PBP. Fat loss is driven by a moderate energy deficit via training volume and simple protein/meal-structure rules rather than daily calorie counting, and every session has a stated purpose so nothing unnecessary is added.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-06

Rebuild & Habit Base

FOCUS

Re-establish aerobic fitness and training habits through flat ERG endurance rides, long weekend durability, easy run-walk, and back-safe strength and hip mobility without vault, sprint, plyometric, or excessive intensity work.

RATIONALE

The block remains a six-week aerobic and habit rebuild, but the first week is adjusted downward after the unplanned 25 October hike and the early strength session. The athlete needs consistency without accumulating fatigue, so the initial week contains one steady ERG ride, one controlled run-walk, one long hike, and a reduced strength exposure with three recovery or rest days. Subsequent weeks add small, sustainable amounts of aerobic volume and strength practice while keeping intensity low. FTP estimates

remain conservative because the athlete is rebuilding from detraining and has not yet demonstrated a sustained training response.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Habit establishment and aerobic re-entry with flat ERG riding, a long hike anchor, easy run-walk, and back-safe strength and hip mobility.

RATIONALE

The 25 October 3 hour 20 minute hike was a substantial unplanned endurance load, and the 27 October strength activity was completed before the full planned gym session could be performed. This week therefore uses one steady ERG ride, a controlled run-walk, and the Sunday five-hour hike as the main anchors, with no compensatory riding or extra intensity. The strength session is reduced to gentle mobility and controlled loading to protect the back and preserve freshness for the hike. All aerobic work remains easy, with the ERG ride capped at approximately 148 W and heart rate below 145 bpm.

Today's workout

Tomorrow — 2026-10-27 (today is a rest day)

> Today, 2026-10-26, is a rest day: **Rest and gentle mobility** — Full rest from structured training. Optional easy hip and thoracic mobility for 10-15 minutes only, without forcing range of motion.

Title	Back-safe strength and mobility
Type / intensity	workout / moderate
Duration	21 min
Status	completed

DESCRIPTION

The recorded 21-minute strength session is completed. Do not repeat the full routine or add conditioning. On another day, progress only with controlled technique: goblet squats at 12 kg for 3 sets of 8-10 repetitions, stopping before the quad burn becomes excessive; light Romanian deadlifts for 2 sets of 8 repetitions with a strict hinge and no back twinge; lat pulldowns for 3 sets of 8-10 repetitions; Pallof presses for 3 sets of 10 per side; and planks for 3 sets of 30-45 seconds. Finish with 10-15 minutes of hip and thoracic mobility.

RATIONALE

The completed strength session builds the back-safe hip-hinge, squat, anti-rotation, and trunk-endurance qualities needed for a more upright, lower-back-friendly cycling position and for long rides. It also supports fat loss by preserving muscle while the athlete rebuilds his training habit. The session was kept short and controlled because the preceding hike had already provided a substantial endurance load.

OPTIONALITY

This session was not optional: it directly develops the back, hip, and core strength needed for long-distance cycling and reduces the sit-bone and back-ache problems that limit ride duration. It is complete, so no additional work is needed.

ALTERNATIVES

- No additional training today
- Only gentle mobility if the back and legs feel completely settled

PLAN 6 OF 6 · 2026-10-28-SIX-MODEL-MERCURY-RERUN

Z.ai GLM-5.3

z-ai/glm-5.3

Full plan	68.3 s / $0.0307
Week + day refresh	68.8 s / $0.0393
Total	**137.1 s / $0.0701**

Season

2026-10-26 → 2027-08-21

GOAL

Finish the randonneur brevet series (200 km in April through 600 km) and complete Paris-Brest-Paris in August 2027, while losing fat from 24.5% to ~15% body fat, building back-safe hip and core strength, and developing general cycling fitness for longer tour races.

RATIONALE

The athlete is currently detrained (estimated FTP ~220 W vs 280 W when fit) after a successful 1130 km bikepacking race in July and a long break, so the season must start with a gentle rebuild that re-establishes the training habit without intensity. He also believes — correctly, and consistent with periodization science — that sustained peak-form training only works for a limited stretch (he has historically maintained disciplined training for a maximum of 4 months). The plan therefore keeps the first ~5 months as low-discipline foundation work: easy aerobic volume, fat loss through diet structure and gradual energy deficit, back-safe progressive gym strength, hip mobility, and beginner running and rowing programs, with Norwegian winter cross-training (cross-country skiing, snowshoeing, fatbike) replacing road rides from December through February. The disciplined, race-specific phase is deliberately compressed into the final ~4.5 months before PBP: a spring return to tarmac in March, the 200 km brevet in April as the first milestone, a progressive brevet build through May and June that also lifts FTP with indoor ERG intervals, a PBP-specific block in July with back-to-back long rides and climbing durability work, and a short taper into the August start. This ordering matches his own experience of how long he can train optimally, ensures every workout in the final phase has a clear purpose, and uses the long foundation to keep the base from falling further behind while fat loss and hip flexibility — which need months, not weeks — progress steadily in the background.

First block

2026-10-26 → 2026-12-06

Rebuild & Fat Loss Foundation

FOCUS

Re-establish the training habit with easy, surge-free aerobic work (flat ERG rides at 140-160 W, easy run/walks, weekend hikes), back-safe gym strength (goblet squats, light RDLs, core), daily hip mobility, and structured evening eating for gradual fat loss. No hard intervals, no spinning classes, no pole vaulting or plyometrics.

RATIONALE

After the July bikepacking race and a long detraining break, the priority is habit, not intensity: consistent easy aerobic sessions rebuild the aerobic base, back-safe progressive lifting restores hip and trunk strength without risking his easily-injured back, and a modest sustainable energy deficit drives slow fat loss toward 15% body fat. Power stays capped at 140-160 W (well under his ~220 W current FTP) so every session is surge-free, with the weekly long hike as the durability anchor. Week 1 was adjusted in place: Tuesday's gym session was completed early, so Wednesday became an easy ERG ride plus mobility

instead of a second strength session, keeping the week light around Sunday's 5-hour hike. All vault, sprint, and plyometric content is removed per the athlete's request. FTP is expected to recover only slightly (220 to ~228 W) since the work is deliberately easy; bigger gains come in later blocks.

First week

Week starting 2026-10-26

FOCUS

Re-entry week: easy surge-free aerobic work, back-safe gym strength, and the 5-hour hike anchor on Sunday 1 November.

RATIONALE

Week 1 of the Rebuild & Fat Loss Foundation block stays deliberately light: one gym strength session, two short flat ERG rides, one easy run/walk, and full rest before Sunday's 5-hour hike. The unplanned Selbu hike on 25 Oct added aerobic volume just before the week, so everything midweek is capped (ERG at 140-148 W, HR under 145) to arrive fresh for the anchor. No spinning classes, no hard intervals, no pole vaulting.

Today's workout

Tomorrow — 2026-10-27 (today is a rest day)

> Today, 2026-10-26, is a rest day: **Rest day** — Full rest to open the Rebuild & Fat Loss Foundation block. Optional 10 minutes of gentle hip mobility in the evening (90/90 hip switches, supported deep squat holds, couch stretch) — no training stress today.

Title	Back-safe gym strength
Type / intensity	workout / moderate
Duration	40 min
Status	planned

DESCRIPTION

Gym session, ~40 min total: 5 min easy rowing warm-up (HR under 130). Goblet squats 3x10 at 12 kg (third set added now that day-one quad burn is known). Romanian deadlifts 2x10 light (10-15 kg) with a strict hip hinge — stop at any back twinge. Glute bridges 3x12. Lat pulldowns 3x10, progressing from 40 to 50 kg. Pallof press 3x10/side. Planks 3x30-45s. Finish with 8-10 minutes of hip stretching. No pole vaulting, no plyometrics.

RATIONALE

This is the week's one strength dose: rebuilding the hip and trunk strength that protects your back on long climbs and later supports a lower, more sustainable riding position for the brevet series and PBP.

OPTIONALITY

Skipping it costs the slow strength foundation that takes months to build — exactly the work that cannot be crammed into the 2027 race phase, and the hinge pattern directly addresses your sit-bone and back issues on long rides.